

IRB consent form

University of Chicago Online Consent Form for Research Participation

Study Number: IRB26-1418

Study Title: Happiness Predictions

Researcher(s): Devin Pope

Collaborating Institutions: University of Wisconsin
Madison

Description:

We are researchers at the University of Chicago doing a research study about how people perceive happiness across different groups in the U.S. The survey will take approximately 7 minutes and involves predicting the average happiness of various demographic groups, along with answering some questions about yourself. The survey is restricted to current U.S. residents with a 99% or greater Prolific approval rating and who have completed at least 20 Prolific surveys and are fluent in English. Your participation is voluntary.

Incentives: You will receive \$2.45 for completing this survey. Payment will be made upon completion through Prolific. If you do not complete the survey, you will not receive payment.

Risks and Benefits: Your participation in this study does not involve any risk to you beyond that of everyday life. Taking part in this research study may not benefit you personally, but we may learn new things that could help others.

Confidentiality: All responses are collected anonymously; no directly identifying information is collected, and no coding system links responses to individual participants. Because data is anonymous from the point of collection, if you withdraw before completing the survey, no data will have been recorded to remove. Since responses cannot be linked back to any individual, we are unable to identify and remove a specific participant's data after submission. No identifiable data will be shared, as none is collected. De-identified, anonymized data from this study may be shared publicly alongside publication of the research findings.

Contacts & Questions: If you have questions or concerns about the study, you can contact the research team through Hannah Lybbert,
hannah.lybbert@chicagobooth.edu

If you have any questions about your rights as a participant in this research, feel you have been harmed, or wish to discuss other study-related concerns with someone who is not part of the research team, you can contact the University of Chicago Social & Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board (IRB) Office by phone at (773) 702-2915, or by email at sbs-irb@uchicago.edu.

Consent: Participation is voluntary. Refusal to participate or withdrawing from the research will involve no penalty or loss of benefits to which you might otherwise be entitled.

By clicking “Yes” below, you confirm that you have read the consent form, are at least 18 years old, and agree to participate in the research. Please print or save a copy of this page for your records.

. Do you wish to participate in this research study?

- ☐ Yes, I wish to participate
- ☐ No, I do not wish to participate

Respondent happiness

. Thank you for taking this survey. It should take about **5–10 minutes** to complete.

To get started, we have a very simple question for you:

. Taken all together, how would you say things are these days -- would you say that you are very happy, pretty happy, or not too happy?

- ☐ Very happy
- ☐ Pretty happy
- ☐ Not too happy

Survey Introduction

. You just answered a question about your own happiness. That same question — "Taken all together, how would you say things are these days—would you say that you are very happy, pretty happy, or not too happy?" — has been asked on a survey to a large number of American adults from 2004–2024. Responses were converted to numbers: 1 = Not too happy, 2 = Pretty happy, 3 = Very happy. The overall average happiness was 2.09 out of 3.

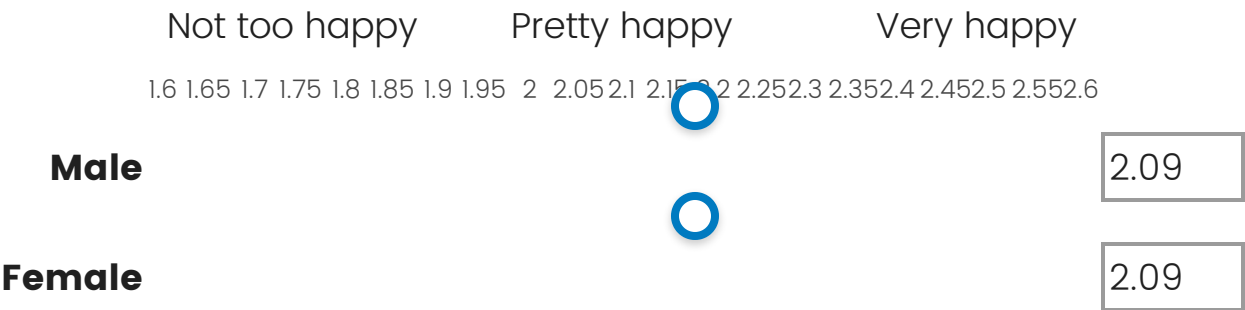
We are interested in your predictions about which groups in the United States are the happiest. For different groups of Americans, please use the sliders on the following page to indicate **how happy you think that group is on average**.

Important: Happiness levels for different groups are available in public data, and AI tools could also generate these estimates. We're not testing your ability to look up the right answer — we want to know what you intuitively think. Please answer using your **own knowledge and best guess**, without searching the internet or using AI tools.

Happiness Prediction Questions

. **Reminder:** happiness is measured on a scale of 1 = Not too happy, 2 = Pretty happy, 3 = Very happy. The dashed line on each slider marks the national average of 2.09

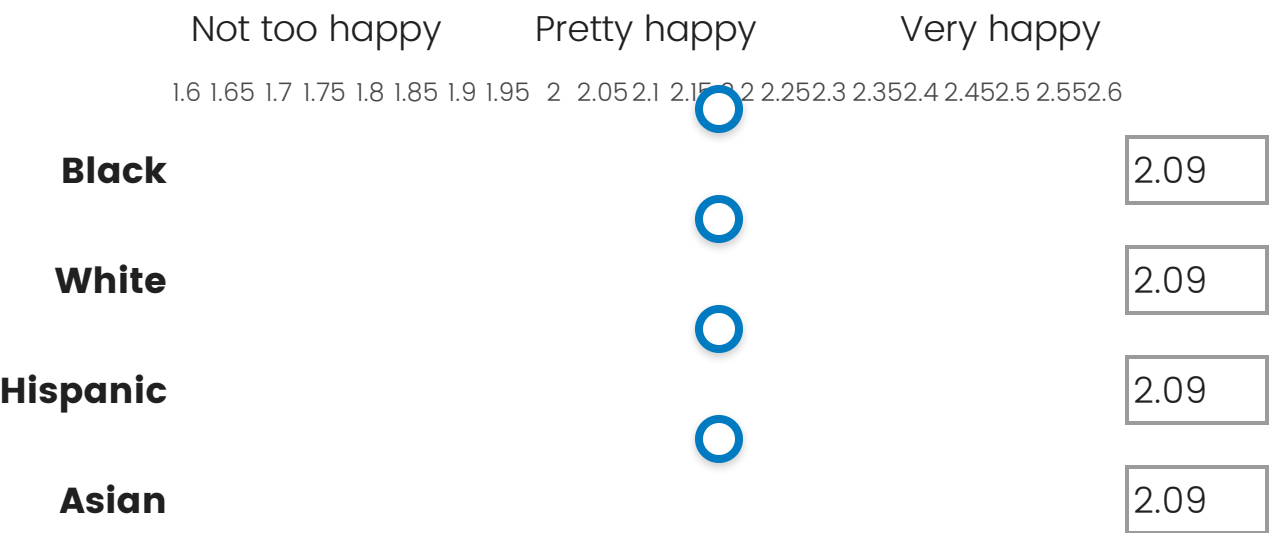
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **sex**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **age**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **race**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **education**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **household income**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **marital status**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on whether they have **ever had children**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on frequency of **religious attendance**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **political party**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on the **type of area where they live**



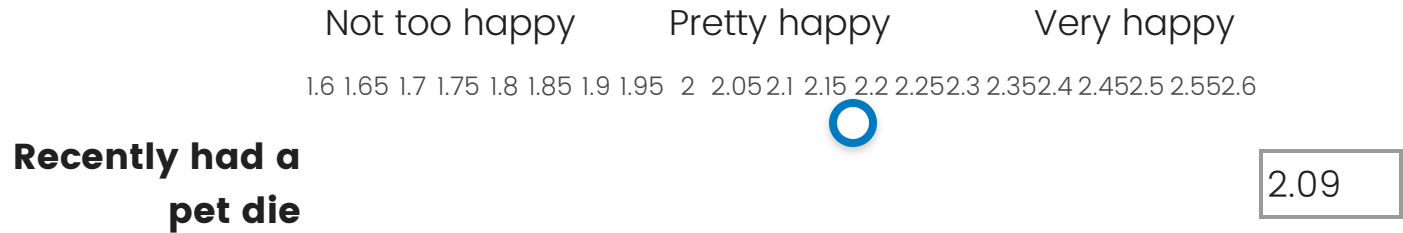
. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **physical health** status

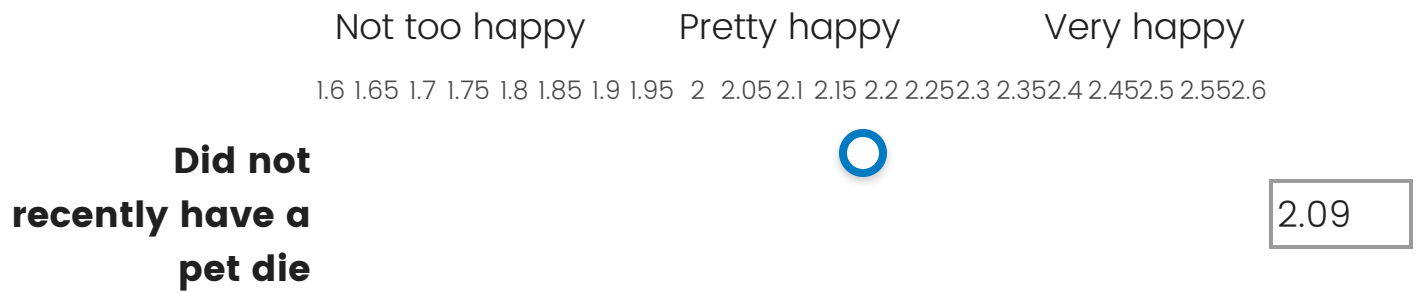


. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on how often they **socialize with friends**



. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **recent life event**

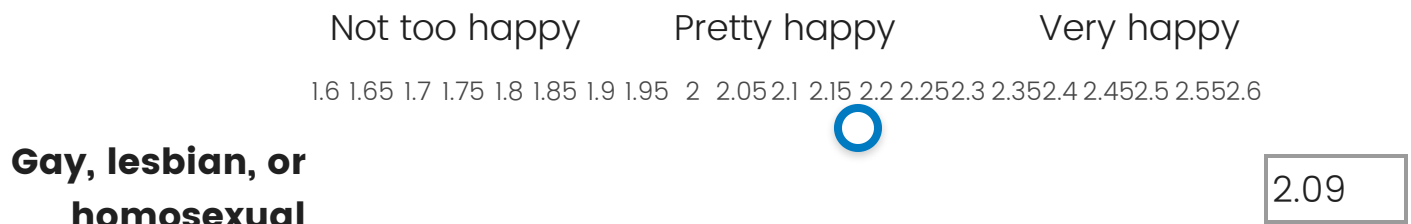


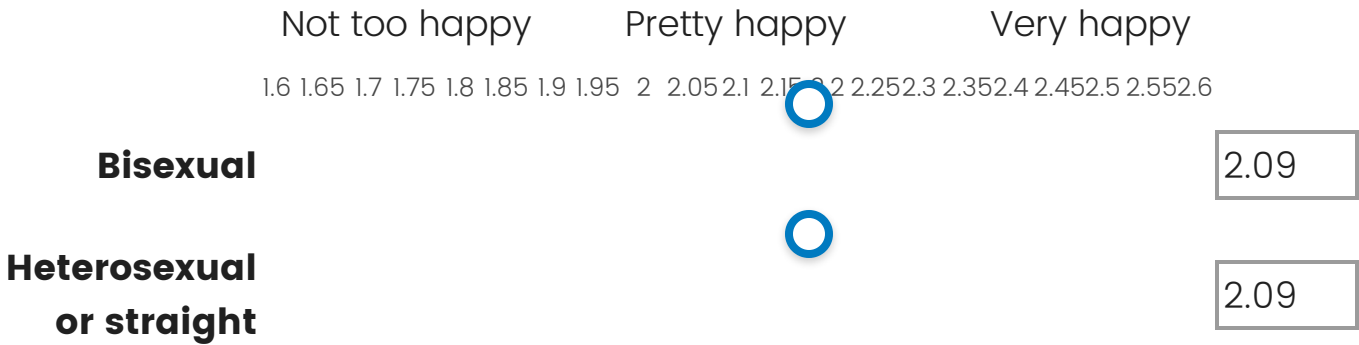


. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **recent life event**

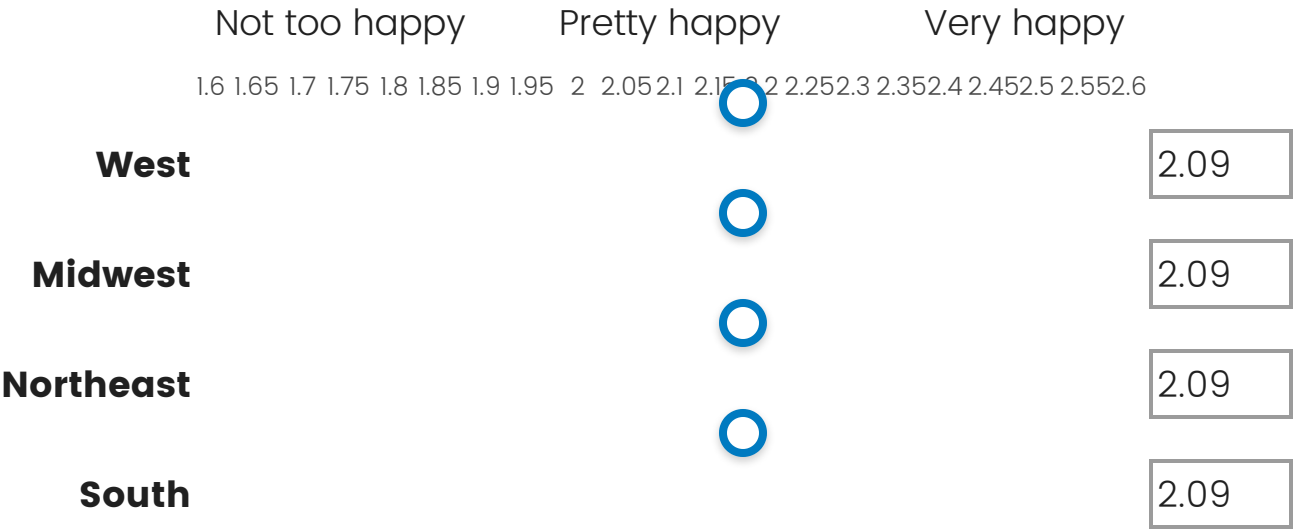


. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on **sexual orientation**





. Predict the average happiness levels for each group based on the **region of the U.S. where they live**



Respondent Demographics questions

. And now, a few final questions about you.

. How old are you?

- ☐ 18-24
- ☐ 25-34
- ☐ 35-44
- ☐ 45-54
- ☐ 55-64
- ☐ 65+

. What is your sex?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Other

. What do you consider your primary race?

- ☐ White
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Asian
- ☐ Hispanic
- ☐ Other

. What is the highest level of education you have completed?

- ☐ Less than high school
- ☐ High school
- ☐ Associate/Junior college
- ☐ Bachelor's
- ☐ Graduate

. In which of these groups did your total family income, from all sources, fall last year before taxes?

- ☐ Less than \$50,000
- ☐ \$50,000-\$115,000
- ☐ Greater than \$115,000

. Are you currently married, widowed, divorced, separated, or have you never been married?

- ☐ Married
- ☐ Widowed
- ☐ Divorced
- ☐ Separated
- ☐ Never married

. How many children have you ever had? Please count all that were born alive at any time (including any you had from a previous marriage).

- ☐ 0
- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5 or more

. How often do you attend religious services?

- ☐ Several times a week
- ☐ Every week
- ☐ Nearly every week
- ☐ 2-3 times a month
- ☐ About once a month
- ☐ Several times a year
- ☐ About once a year
- ☐ Less than once a year
- ☐ Never

. Generally speaking, do you usually think of yourself as a Republican, Democrat, Independent, or another party?

- ☐ Strong democrat
- ☐ Not very strong democrat
- ☐ Independent, close to democrat
- ☐ Independent (neither)
- ☐ Independent, close to republican
- ☐ Not very strong republican
- ☐ Strong republican
- ☐ Other party

. Which best describes the area where you currently live?

- ☐ Big city (over 250,000)
- ☐ Medium size city (50,000 to 250,000)
- ☐ Suburb of a big or medium size city
- ☐ Small town (10,000 to 49,999)
- ☐ Rural town (1,000 to 9,999)

. Would you say your own health, in general, is excellent, good, fair, or poor?

- ☐ Excellent
- ☐ Good

- ☐ Fair
- ☐ Poor

. Please select the answer that comes closest to how often you spend a social evening with friends.

- ☐ Almost daily
- ☐ Once or twice a week
- ☐ Several times a month
- ☐ About once a month
- ☐ Several times a year
- ☐ About once a year
- ☐ Never

. Which state the U.S. do you currently live in?

. Which of the following best describes you?

- ☐ Gay, lesbian, or homosexual
- ☐ Bisexual
- ☐ Heterosexual or straight
- ☐ Other

Powered by Qualtrics